SANTIAGO TOBÓN, PHD

Professor of Economics, School of Finance, Economics and Government, Universidad EAFIT
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Academic Employment

2020– Professor of Economics (tenured), Universidad EAFIT
2025– Director, Centro de Valor Público—EAFIT's applied policy research center, Universidad EAFIT
2019–20 Professor of Economics (untenured), Universidad EAFIT
2024 Visiting Scholar, UNU World Institute for Development Economics Research (UNU-WIDER), Helsinki
2023 Visiting Scholar, Inter-American Development Bank, Washington, DC
2022 Visiting Professor, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy, Chicago
2017–19 Postdoctoral Scholar, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy & Innovations for Poverty Action
2016–17 Doctoral Scholar, Innovations for Poverty Action
2016 Visiting Doctoral Student, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy

Other Affiliations

2026– Chair, AL CAPONE—América Latina Crime and Policy Network
2024– Non-Resident Senior Research Fellow, UNU-WIDER
2024– Affiliate, J-PAL—Crime and Violence Initiative
2020– Academic Member, Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP); Board Member
2016– Researcher, Innovations for Poverty Action

Education

2014–18 Ph.D., Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá. Dissertation with distinction
2014–17 M.A., Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá
2011–12 M.A., Economics, Université catholique de Louvain, Louvain-la-Neuve. *Grande distinction*
2009–11 M.A., Business, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín
2002–07 B.A., Computer Science, Universidad EIA, Envigado

Fields of Study

Economics of crime, Organized crime and criminal governance, Drug policy, Policing and criminal justice, Development economics, Political economy

Prizes and Honors

2024 Medellín Investiga Prize, awarded every year to the best research project on Medellín's main development challenges
2020 Juan Luis Londoño Medal, awarded every two years to Colombians of 40 years or less for the impact of their research and policy work on the welfare of Colombians

Conference Organization

2027 Host, 20th Annual Conference of the International Society for the Study of Drug Policy (ISSDP), EAFIT, Medellín
2027 Host, AL CAPONE Annual Meeting, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín
2025 Host, EGAP 29 Meeting, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín
2023 Local host, 20th IEA World Congress, Medellín

Books

2027 *Cocaína: Anatomía de un mercado prohibido*. Under contract, Penguin Random House Grupo Editorial; expected 2027.
Forth. *Wartime Taxation: State-building, State Capacity and the Role of Formal and Informal Taxes*, edited with Patricia Justino, Zachariah Mampilly, Gauthier Marchais, and Anna D'Souza. Oxford University Press, in production.

Academic Publications

Journal Articles

2027 "Organized Crime and Violence," with Maria Micaela Sviatschi and Nicolás Cabra-Ruiz, *Annual Review of Economics* 19, forthcoming.
2026 "State-Building in the City: An Experiment in Civilian Alternatives to Policing," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, *American Political Science Review* 120(4): 1337–1355.
2026 "Implementation Outcomes of a CBT-Based Psychosocial Intervention for Gang-Recruitment-Vulnerable Youth in Medellín: A Qualitative Study of Novice Provider Experiences," with Mariantonia Lemos, Gabriela Algarín, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, *Cambridge Prisms: Global Mental Health* 13: e174.
2025 "Gang Rule: Understanding and Countering Criminal Governance," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, *Review of Economic Studies* 92(3): 1497–1531.
2023 "Production and Persistence of Criminal Skills: Evidence from a High-Crime Context," with Maria A. Escobar and Martín Vanegas-Arias, *Journal of Development Economics* 160: 102969.

2023 "The Perils of Military Policing," (invited commentary), *Nature Human Behaviour* 7(6): 843–844.

2022 "Do Better Prisons Reduce Recidivism? Evidence from a Prison Construction Program," *The Review of Economics and Statistics* 104(6): 1256–1272.

2021 "Place-Based Interventions at Scale: The Direct and Spillover Effects of Policing and City Services on Crime," with Christopher Blattman, Donald Green, and Daniel Ortega, *Journal of the European Economic Association* 19(4): 2022–2051.

2021 "Hot Spots Policing in a High-Crime Environment: An Experimental Evaluation in Medellín," with Daniela Collazos, Eduardo García, Daniel Mejía, and Daniel Ortega, *Journal of Experimental Criminology* 17(3): 473–506.

2021 "The Deterrent Effect of Surveillance Cameras on Crime," with Santiago Gómez and Daniel Mejía, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management* 40(2): 553–571.

2021 "Crises Conducting Stakeholder Salience: Shifts in the Evolution of Private Universities' Governance in Latin America," with M.A. Gonzalez-Perez, M. Cordova, M. Hermans, K.M. Nava-Aguirre, F. Monje-Cueto, S. Mingo, C.A. Rodriguez, E.H. Salvaj, and D.E. Floriani, *Corporate Governance: The International Journal of Business in Society* 21(6): 1194–1214.

2021 "Community Policing in the Developing World," (invited commentary), *Science* 374(6571): 1046–1047.

2020 "Meta-Analysis of Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation in Major Histocompatibility Complex Class II Deficiency," with L.M. Castaño-Jaramillo, J. Bareño-Silva, and A.F. Escobar-Gonzalez, *Pediatric Transplantation* 24(6): e13774.

2018 "The Role of Land Property Rights in the War on Illicit Crops: Evidence from Colombia," with Juan Carlos Muñoz-Mora and Jesse W. d'Anjou, *World Development* 103: 268–283.

Book Chapters

Forth. "Concealed Costs: Illicit Economies and the Erosion of the Local Tax Base in Colombia," with Patricia Justino, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Juan F. Vargas, in *Wartime Taxation: State-building, State Capacity and the Role of Formal and Informal Taxes*, P. Justino et al., Eds., Oxford University Press.

2023 "Crime: Economics of, the Standard Approach," with Paolo Buonanno and Juan F. Vargas, in *Encyclopedia of Law and Economics*, A. Marciano and G.B. Ramello, Eds., Springer; updated edition 2026.

2022 "Prisons," with Paolo Buonanno and Juan F. Vargas, in *Encyclopedia of Law and Economics*, A. Marciano and G.B. Ramello, Eds., Springer.

2022 "Broken Windows Policing and Crime: Evidence from 80 Colombian Cities," with Daniel Mejía, Ervyn Norza, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, in *A Modern Guide to the Economics of Crime*, P. Buonanno, P. Vanin, and J. Vargas, Eds., Edward Elgar Publishing, pp. 55–87.

Literature Reviews

2025 "Organised Crime and Development," with Maria Micaela Sviatschi and Nicolás Cabra-Ruiz, *VoxDevLit* 17(1).

Working Papers & Papers under Review

"Respect, Neutrality, and Police Legitimacy: A Representative Vignette Experiment in Post-Conflict Colombia," with Verónica Abril, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Martín Vanegas-Arias. Conditionally accepted, *Justice Quarterly*

"Votes Follow Stakes: Peace Negotiations and Electoral Shifts in Armed-Group Territories," with Michael Weintraub. Reject and resubmit, *American Political Science Review*

"Education, Youth Development, and Organized-Crime Recruitment in Developing Countries," with Martín Vanegas-Arias. Revised and resubmitted, *World Development*

"The Prohibition Trap: Rents, Violence, and Welfare in the Global Cocaine Chain," with Juan F. Vargas and Michael Weintraub

"Prison Governance and the Purposes of Punishment," with Ernesto Schargrodsky

"Who Joins Drug-Selling Gangs and Why? Beliefs and Recruitment Risk among 10,000 Adolescent Boys," with Christopher Blattman and Arantxa Rodríguez-Uribe

"Pax Criminalis," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, Benjamin Lessing, and Juan F. Martínez

"Gangs of Medellín: How Organized Crime Is Organized," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing

"Building Trust in the Police: Evidence from a Multi-Site Experiment in Colombia," with Verónica Abril, Ervyn Norza, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Michael Weintraub

"How Illegal Income Improves Schooling: Cocaine Production and Education in Colombia," with Ivonne Lara, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Juan F. Vargas

"Do Illegal Economies Reduce Local Fiscal Capacity?" with Patricia Justino, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Juan F. Vargas

Policy Notes and Reports

2026 "Beneficios jurídicos en juego: la Paz Total y el voto en territorios de grupos armados," with Michael Weintraub, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT, Policy Note 11.

2026 "Beyond the Mine: Sizing Colombia's Illegal Gold Economy," Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT, Policy Note

10.

2026 "The Producer's Cut: Sizing Colombia's Cocaine Economy," with Daniel Mejía, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT, Policy Note 9.

2026 "Education and Youth Pathways Under Organized Crime," with Martín Vanegas-Arias, Organized Against Crime, Policy Document 9.

2026 "Construcción de Estado en la ciudad: lecciones de un experimento en alternativas civiles a la policía en Medellín," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT, Policy Note 8.

2026 "From Schools of Crime to Criminal Hubs? Prisons and Organized Crime in Latin America and the Caribbean," with Ernesto Schargrodsky, Organized Against Crime, Policy Document 3.

2026 "Improving Officials' Use of Evidence in the Design and Implementation of Public Policy," with Manuela Hoyos, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, Pedro C. L. Souza, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, IDB Working Paper.

2025 "¿Qué funciona para reducir la impunidad y la reincidencia por violencia de género? Evidencia de dos evaluaciones de impacto en Colombia," with Verónica Abril, Brayan Pineda, and María José Sotomayor, IDB Working Paper.

2025 "The Political Will to Measure Organised Crime: Why We Need It and How to Build It," with Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, SOC ACE Briefing Note 34.

2025 "How to Map and Combat Urban Organised Crime: Lessons from the Medellín Impact Lab," with Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, SOC ACE Briefing Note 33.

2024 "Gobierno de pandillas: entendiendo y contrarrestando la gobernanza criminal," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT.

2023 "Building Trust in State Actors: A Multi-Site Experiment with the Colombian National Police," with Verónica Abril, Ervyn Norza, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Michael Weintraub, IDB Technical Note IDB-TN-2790.

2022 "The Terrible Trade-Off: Why Governments Must Choose between More Violence or Stronger Gangs," with Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, Modern War Institute at West Point.

2022 "The Terrible Trade-Off: How the Hidden Cost of Organised Crime Harms Cities, and What Can Be Done about It," with Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, SOC ACE Briefing Note 4.

2022 "Measuring Organised Crime: Challenges and Solutions for Collecting Data on Armed Illicit Groups," with Christopher Blattman, Benjamin Lessing, and Juan Pablo Mesa-Mejía, SOC ACE Briefing Note 3.

2020 "The Evolution of Citizen Security in Colombia in Times of COVID-19," with Nathalie Alvarado, Ervyn Norza, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, IDB Technical Note IDB-TN-2034.

2020 "Crime in the Time of COVID-19," with Christopher Blattman, David Cerero, Gustavo Duncan, et al., EDI Report, COVID-19 Essay Series.

2020 "Gobierno criminal en Medellín: panorama general del fenómeno y evidencia empírica sobre cómo enfrentarlo," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, Benjamin Lessing, and Juan Pablo Mesa-Mejía, Documentos de Trabajo de Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT.

2018 "What Works to Prevent Violence among Youth? A White Paper on Youth Violence, Crime Prevention and the Mexican Context," with Thomas Abt, Christopher Blattman, and Beatriz Magaloni, USAID Report.

2016 "Sector Wide Impact Assessment on Human Rights: Mining Unseen," with Luis Fernando De Angulo, Camila Miranda, et al., Institute for Human Rights and Business Report.

Other Publications (Spanish-Language and Early Work)

2022 "Crimen y Covid-19. Cómo los combos de Medellín respondieron a la pandemia," with Christopher Blattman, David Cerero, Gustavo Duncan, Sebastián Hernández, Benjamin Lessing, Juan F. Martínez, Juan Pablo Mesa-Mejía, and Helena Montoya, in *Covid-19: consecuencias y desafíos en la economía colombiana. Una mirada desde las universidades*, D. Cortés, C. Posso, and M. Villamizar-Villegas, Eds., Banco de la República, pp. 243–264.

2019 "El gasto fiscal de la guerra contra los portadores de drogas ilícitas: una aproximación para Colombia," with Isabel Gutiérrez, *Lecturas de Economía* 91: 79–116.

2017 "El ciclo criminal del microtráfico y consumo de drogas: contexto nacional y consecuencias en entornos locales," with Isabel Gutiérrez, in *Territorios y sociabilidades violentas*, J. Giraldo, Ed., Editorial EAFIT.

2016 "La situación del narcotráfico en Colombia ad portas del posacuerdo," with Isabel Gutiérrez, Camila Suárez, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Gustavo Duncan, in *Contribuciones de la Universidad a la Agenda de La Habana*, J. Giraldo, Ed., Editorial EAFIT.

2016 "Evaluación y seguimiento a las actividades de la policía de vigilancia," with Isabel Gutiérrez, in *Gestión territorial de la seguridad en el posconflicto*, I. Gutiérrez, Ed., Universidad EAFIT and CESEP.

2016 "La inversión obligatoria y el crédito agropecuario en Colombia," with Dairo Estrada and Paula Zuleta, in *El desarrollo equitativo, competitivo y sostenible del sector agropecuario en Colombia*, C. G. Cano et al., Eds., Banco de la República.

2014 "The Rational Expectations Hypothesis: An Assessment on Its Real World Application," *Ecos de Economía* 18(39): 37–47.

2013 "Impuesto predial y desarrollo económico: aproximación a la relación entre el impuesto predial y la inversión de los municipios de Antioquia," with Juan Carlos Muñoz-Mora, *Ecos de Economía* 17(36): 173–198.

2013 "Instituciones y cultivos ilícitos," in *Economía criminal y poder político*, J. Giraldo, Ed., Editorial EAFIT.

Grants

2026– Templeton World Charity Foundation, "Empowering Occupational Choice for At-Risk Adolescent Girls in Medellín," $250,000

2026–27 J-PAL Crime and Violence Initiative, "Evaluating an Intervention to Reduce Youth Gang Involvement," $124,291

2026– The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, "The Long-Run Economic Returns to Treating Adolescent Mental Illness," $25,000

2025–26 University of Birmingham, Serious Organised Crime & Anti-Corruption Evidence (SOC ACE) programme, "Developing Government Information and Accountability Systems for Combating Serious Organised Crime: Medellín Demonstration Project," £49,253

2025–26 The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, "Testing a Behavior Change Approach to Counter Criminal Youth Recruitment," $130,000

2024–27 Wellspring Philanthropic Fund, Medellín organized-crime research agenda (behavioral prevention in schools, anti-extortion experiment, city-wide organized-crime survey), $600,000

2024–26 National Science Foundation, award 2343694 (via University of Chicago), "Understanding and Preventing Gang Entry: A Longitudinal and Experimental Study," $555,570 (co-PI)

2024–26 J-PAL Innovation in Government Initiative (via Innovations for Poverty Action), "Reducing Criminal Behaviors among 100,000 High-Risk Youth in Colombia," $157,653

2024–25 Minerva Research Initiative, U.S. Department of Defense, "Youth Recruitment into Criminal Organizations in Latin America," $2,200,000. Award terminated by the funder in the 2025 U.S. federal grant cancellations

2024–25 USAID Development Innovation Ventures, "Countering Criminal Youth Recruitment," $199,802. Award terminated by the funder in the 2025 U.S. federal grant cancellations

2023–26 IPA Human Trafficking Research Initiative (U.S. Department of State), "Understanding How to Reduce Adolescent Recruitment into Gangs: Experimental Evidence in Medellín, Colombia," $285,907 (co-PI)

2022–24 Sistema General de Regalías, Gobierno de Colombia, "Estudios sobre pandillas, crimen urbano y gobierno criminal en Antioquia," $840,000

2022–23 Templeton World Charity Foundation, "Childhood Adversity, Misperceptions, and Gang Recruitment," $235,000

2022 Towards Kindness, "Understanding Gang Entry and Exit in Medellín, Colombia," $200,000

2022 Inter-American Development Bank, "Building Trust in State Actors: A Multi-Site Experiment with the Colombian National Police," $130,000

2021–23 Ministerio de Ciencia, Tecnología e Innovación, "Crimen urbano y políticas de seguridad en Colombia y América Latina: Reclutamiento, gobierno criminal y policía militarizada," $400,000

2020–23 Universidad EAFIT, "Improving Human Decisions through Machine Learning: An Experiment to Reduce Crime by Selecting Inmates Better," $100,000

2020–21 Innovations for Poverty Action Peace and Recovery Program, "Gang Entry and Exit: Behavioral Biases and Gang Recruitment," $50,000

2020–21 Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago, "COVID-19, Crises, and Support for the Rule of Law: Organized Crime in Rio de Janeiro's Favelas," $35,000

2020–21 Foreign and Commonwealth Office, UK, "How Organized Crime Is Responding to the COVID-19 Crisis," $35,000

2020–21 Universidad EAFIT, "Organized Crime in Rio de Janeiro: Understanding Non-State Provision of Order and Justice," $40,000

2020 J-PAL Crime and Violence Initiative, "The Other Virus: How Gangs and Organized Crime Are Responding to the COVID-19 Crisis," $50,000

2019–21 National Science Foundation, award 1851543 (via University of Chicago), "Experimental Impacts of Intensive Municipal Governance and Community Organization on Gang Governance," $450,000 (co-PI)

2019 J-PAL Crime and Violence Initiative, "Contesting Criminal Gang Governance in Medellín," $100,000

2019 Fundación para el Desarrollo de Antioquia (Proantioquia), "Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Map Order and Violence at the Micro Level," $70,000

2018 Secretaría de Seguridad de Medellín, "Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Map Order and Violence at the Micro Level," $33,000

2018 Proantioquia, "Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Map Order and Violence at the Micro Level," $70,000

2017–18 J-PAL Latin America and Caribbean, "Strategies and Programs to Prevent Violence among Youth," $32,000

2017–18 Economic Development and Institutions (EDI), "Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Understand Variation in Non-State Provision of Order and Justice," $100,000

2017–18 CESED/Postobón, Universidad de los Andes, "Gangs of Medellín," $10,000

2017–18 CESED/Open Society Foundations, Universidad de los Andes, "Gangs of Medellín," $10,000

2016–17 3ie Development Priorities Window, "Increasing State and Police Presence in the Least Governed Areas of Bogotá: A Hot Spot Policing Approach," $280,000

2016–17 J-PAL Governance Initiative, "State-Building on the Intensive and Extensive Margins: Testing Urban Violence Reduction through Policing and Public Services in Bogotá," $360,000
2016–17 CAF—Development Bank of Latin America, "The Impact of Hotspot Policing and Municipal Services on Crime: Experimental Evidence from Bogotá," $50,000
2016–17 J-PAL Government Partnership Initiative, "The Impact of Hotspot Policing and Municipal Services on Crime: Experimental Evidence from Bogotá," $20,000
2016 CESED/Postobón, Universidad de los Andes, "Prison Overcrowding and Recidivism: Evidence from Colombia," $10,000
2016 CESED/Open Society Foundations, Universidad de los Andes, "El Sistema de Justicia Criminal en la lucha contra el consumo de drogas ilícitas," $10,000

Policy Positions and Consulting

2025 Consultant, Prisons and Organized Crime, Office of the Chief Economist for Latin America and the Caribbean, World Bank
2025 Consultant, Education and Organized Crime, CAF—Development Bank of Latin America
2021–22 Consultant, Police Reform, National Police of Colombia
2021–22 Consultant, Policy Analysis and Evaluation, Federación Nacional de Departamentos
2021–22 Consultant, Impact Evaluation, Fundación Acción Interna
2020–21 Consultant, Human Rights, Human Rights Office, Presidency of Colombia
2020–21 Consultant, Human Trafficking, International Organization for Migration
2019–23 Consultant, Innovation in Citizen Services Division, Inter-American Development Bank
2019 Advisor to the Director for Justice, Security and Government, National Planning Department
2018–19 Advisor on Monitoring and Evaluation, International Organization for Migration
2017–18 Advisor to the Deputy Minister for Crime Policy, Ministry of Justice of Colombia
2017–18 Advisor to the Secretary, Secretariat of Security of Bogotá
2017 Consultant, Innovation in Citizen Services Division, Inter-American Development Bank
2015–16 Consultant, CAF—Development Bank of Latin America
2015–16 Consultant, CREER-IHRB Institute for Human Rights and Business
2014–15 Chief of Staff, Senator in the 4th Committee on Economic Affairs, Colombian Congress
2013–14 Advisor, FINAGRO, Colombia's rural development bank
2009–11 Director, Cadastre and Territorial Development, Government of Antioquia, Colombia
2008–09 Director, Economic Development, Government of Antioquia, Colombia

Professional Activities

Teaching

2019– Universidad EAFIT: Microeconomics Seminar—Economics of Crime, Microeconomics Seminar—Development Economics, and Political Economy (undergraduate); Impact Evaluation (graduate)
2022 University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy: Economic Development and Policy (graduate); International Police Reform Policy Lab (graduate)
2016– National Police of Colombia (lecturer): Evidence Based Policing (graduate-equivalent)
2017–19 American University (lecturer): Policing in the Global Context (undergraduate)
2015 Universidad de los Andes (teaching assistant): Economic Theory of Crime (graduate)

PhD Students

2023– Martín Vanegas-Arias, Universidad EAFIT (supervision)
2020–26 César Herrera, Universidad EAFIT (supervision; graduated 2026)
2022 PierFrancesco Rolla, University of Sussex (examination)
2021 Magaly Herrera, Universidad ICESI (examination)

Refereeing

Science, Nature, Quarterly Journal of Economics, American Political Science Review, AER: Insights, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of the European Economic Association, AEJ: Applied, Economic Journal, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Public Economics, Comparative Political Studies, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Nature Human Behaviour, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Defence and Peace Economics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Criminology, Journal of Quantitative Criminology, Journal of Experimental Criminology, Criminology and Public Policy

Public Writing and Media

2015– Public writing on crime, policing, prisons, and drug policy in VoxDev, UNU-WIDER, Foco Económico, Nada es Gratis, Razón Pública, La Silla Vacía, El Colombiano, El Espectador, and the Inter-American Development Bank's Sin Miedos and Enfoque Educación blogs
Regular commentary and analysis in Colombian media, including El Colombiano, El Espectador, La Silla Vacía, and Caracol Radio's Hora 20 panel

Research coverage in *The Economist* (2022; interviewed on police reform, 2020), El Tiempo, Portafolio, El Colombiano, El Espectador, Infobae, Noticias RCN, BluRadio, El Universal, and La Diaria (Uruguay), among others

Podcast appearances: Probable Causation (Ep. 61), The Visible Hand (Ep. 83), Stories of Impact, Governance Loop (EGAP), Huevos Revueltos con Política (La Silla Vacía), Atemporal, El Profesor con Sergio Fajardo, Hablemos de Raíz, and La Tertulia política, among others; short documentary on the Medellín youth-recruitment project, Templeton World Charity Foundation (2024)

Selected Presentations

2026 CAF Research Seminar, Buenos Aires; Universidad de San Andrés Economics Seminar, Buenos Aires; Universidad de Montevideo Economics Seminar; University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy; Universidad EAFIT Economics Seminar; U.S. Department of State TIP Office–IPA Human Trafficking Research Initiative briefing (virtual); CAF Workshop with the Laboratorio de Justicia y Política Criminal, Cali

2025 UNU-WIDER Tax and Conflict Workshop, Helsinki; West Point Social Science Seminar, U.S. Military Academy, West Point, NY; The Interconnection of Latin American Policy Challenges, Columbia University, New York; Empirical Studies of Conflict (ESOC) Annual Meeting, Taipei; AL CAPONE/RIDGE May Forum, Universidad del Pacífico, Lima; University of Chicago Development Economics Seminar; Inter-American Development Bank Regional Summit on Citizen Security and Justice, Buenos Aires (panel on youth recruitment by organized crime); EGAP 29, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín

2024 World Bank Fragility Forum, IDB session on criminal violence in middle-income countries, Washington, DC; UNU-WIDER Research Seminar, Helsinki; University of Chicago and LSE Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice, London; AL CAPONE, Harvard University; EGAP 28, Paris; EGAP Regional Meeting, Rio de Janeiro; Drug Policy Forum, Universidad EAFIT; USAID Latin America Evidence Summit (virtual); UN Financing for Development Dialogues, Academic Day (UNU-WIDER panel), New York; World Bank, Bogotá (Medellín gangs research agenda)

2023 IEA World Congress, Medellín; IDB Research Seminar, Washington, DC; UNU-WIDER Development Conference, Oslo; NBER Summer Institute: Crime, Cambridge, MA; Texas Economics of Crime Conference, Austin, TX; Seminario CAF; AL CAPONE/RIDGE, Montevideo; Empirical Studies of Conflict, Bogotá

2022 American Economic Association Annual Meeting; National Academies Workshop on Building Trust and Legitimacy in Policing; UNU-WIDER Development Conference, Bogotá; American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting, Atlanta; AL CAPONE, Reggio Calabria; UNU-WIDER Puzzle of Peace Conference, Helsinki; CLEAN Seminar; Urban Violence and Collective Memory in the Americas, Geneva; Conference on Criminal Governance, Rio de Janeiro; CIDE Lecture Series on Drug Policy

2021 Niskanen Center Panel Series on Violence Prevention; RIDGE Forum: AL CAPONE; Fedesarrollo; UNODC INEGI Conference on Governance, Crime and Justice Statistics; USAID; Center for Global Development Violence Prevention seminar; University of Chicago and LSE Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice; Universidad Católica de Uruguay Economics Seminar; Congreso Anual Red de Investigadores de Economía

2020 BREAD/CEPR/STICERD/TCD Conference on Development Economics; São Paulo School of Economics; CEPR RPN on Preventing Conflict; University of Chicago Crime Lab; Empirical Studies of Conflict (ESOC); Texas Economics of Crime Workshop, College Station; Latin America Peace Science, Medellín

2019 Annual Colombian Economics Conference, Bogotá; IDB Innovation in Citizen Services Division, Washington, DC; LACEA, Puebla; Universidad EAFIT; What Works Global Summit, México D.F.; REDESDAL, México D.F.; Behavioral Insights in Development and Peace Building, Göttingen; Economic Development and Institutions Annual Conference, Paris; Ministério Público do Estado do Rio de Janeiro; RIDGE Forum: Political Economy Workshop, Medellín; AL CAPONE, Medellín; Cities and Development Workshop, Johns Hopkins SAIS, Washington, DC; International Republican Institute, Panamá; Seminario CEDE CESED, Bogotá

2018 Encuentro Internacional de Observatorios del Delito, Policía Nacional, Bogotá; Households in Conflict Network Workshop, Medellín; Escuela de Posgrados de la Policía Nacional, Bogotá; Proantioquia, Medellín

2017 LACEA, Buenos Aires; Economic Development and Institutions Annual Conference, Namur; Economics of Organized Crime, Bogotá; Seminario de Economía, Banco de la República, Medellín; AL CAPONE, Santiago; Empirical Studies of Conflict, Washington, DC; EGAP 20, Bogotá; Seminario CEDE, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá; National Network for Safe Communities, Tarrytown, NY; Seminario de Economía, Universidad del Rosario, Bogotá

2016 Center for Latin American Studies, Stanford; LACEA, Medellín; University of Chicago Crime Lab; AL CAPONE, Buenos Aires; American Law and Economics Association, Harvard Law School; Seminario Banco de la República, Bogotá

2012–15 LACEA, Santa Cruz de la Sierra, 2015; LACEA, São Paulo, 2014; Seminario de Economía, Banco de la República, Bogotá, 2014; Economías criminales y poder político, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín, 2012